

THE FUTURE IS HERE

We put the spotlight on **three talented teens** that the world should watch out for in men's tennis in 2024.

Paul Fein

They flipped the script. When a promising teen prospect faces his boyhood idol for the first time, he typically raves about his hero afterward.

Instead, after Dino Prizmic, a qualifier from Croatia, battled Novak Djokovic for four hours before yielding 6-2, 6-7 (5), 6-3, 6-4 in the Australian Open first round, it was the undisputed GOAT who heaped praise on the kid.

"I love the way he uses every inch of the court. He is comfortable coming in, he defends incredibly well," said Djokovic in his on-court interview. "Just an amazing performance for someone who is 18 years old and never had an experience of playing on a big stage."

Aside from first-set nerves, No. 171-ranked Prizmic didn't appear the least bit intimidated either by Djokovic or his own Grand Slam main-draw debut on Rod Laver Arena. That was just one of several attributes that impressed the 10-time and defending AO champion.

"I had an amazing opponent tonight,"



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